
SB2BI Integration with IBM ITX

A lecture session bridging what you already know about ITX to Sterling B2B Integrator's own Map Editor, followed immediately by a hands-on lab

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Background

Introduction This lesson covers how IBM Sterling Transformation Extender (ITX) — the product many teams still call by its earlier name, WebSphere Transformation Extender (WTX) — pairs with Sterling B2B Integrator for heavyweight, standards-based data transformation. You are new to Sterling B2B Integrator but already know ITX, so this lesson is built around a direct bridge: every ITX concept you already know is lined up next to its Sterling B2B Integrator equivalent, using Sterling Map Editor rather than ITX for the actual hands-on work.

Session format This is a lecture session — no ITX is installed in this environment, and none is needed. As soon as the lecture wraps, you'll move directly into a hands-on lab, building a complete healthcare claim (837) to remittance (835) flow using only Sterling Map Editor and Sterling B2B Integrator. That lab is a separate, self-contained guide — the 837 to 835 End-to-End Sterling Map Editor Guide — and picks up exactly where this lesson leaves off.

Lesson objectives This lesson is designed to help you to:

- Explain what ITX is, how it relates to WebSphere Transformation Extender (WTX), and why organizations pair it with Sterling B2B Integrator
- Describe the capabilities the WTX-for-Sterling integration adds beyond raw transformation
- Translate what you already know about ITX Design Studio, type trees, and mapping functions into their direct Sterling Map Editor equivalents
- Name any field's required operation using a shared framework of five universal mapping operations — copy, reformat, compute, default, and lookup — that applies equally to ITX and to Map Editor
- List the pieces required for a real ITX integration — Design Studio, runtime, ITXA adapter or container path, and licensing — as a procurement checklist, for the day your organization licenses it
- Walk into the hands-on lab that follows already knowing where every Map Editor screen and term maps back to something you've used in ITX

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What Is IBM Sterling Transformation Extender (ITX)?

Positioning ITX is the current name for a product line also known as WebSphere Transformation Extender (WTX) — a separate, transaction-oriented data integration and translation application. It automates the transformation of high-volume, complex transactions without hard-coding, supporting EDI, XML, SWIFT, and HIPAA standards, plus real-time integration across applications, databases, and messaging middleware.

How SB2BI describes the pairing Sterling B2B Integrator's own product literature describes itself as having "integrated universal transformation capability of IBM WebSphere Transformation Extender with business process management features of Sterling B2B Integrator" — the two products are designed to be paired, not to compete.

ITX Advanced IBM's Standards Processing Engine portfolio ("ITX Advanced") is the next evolution of this Universal Transformation strategy — modular, standards-based document processing spanning WTX, Sterling B2B Integrator, and XSLT translation maps.

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A Brief History: WebSphere Transformation Extender to ITX

Point in time	Detail
Originally	WebSphere Transformation Extender (WTX) — the name many teams still use day to day
Current naming	IBM Sterling Transformation Extender (ITX) — same underlying product line; current IBM documentation and licensing use this name
Current release line	ITX 11.0.x is the current generation per IBM documentation
Watch the calendar	The 10.1.x release line reaches end of support April 30, 2026 — relevant if your organization is planning a purchase or upgrade

ITX / WTX Basics

Transformation engine Performs the actual transformation and routing of data from source systems to target systems, in batch and real-time environments.

Sources Files, relational databases, Message-Oriented Middleware (MOM), packaged applications, or other external sources.

Design Studio The graphical map editor where you build type trees and maps — visually connecting input fields to output fields.

Industry packs Pre-defined support for multiple document standards (EDI, HIPAA, SWIFT, and others), so you're not building standards support from scratch.

Technology adapters A range of adapters connecting ITX to the various source and target systems it needs to reach.

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WTX for Sterling B2B Integrator: Integration Capabilities

Why integrate WebSphere Transformation Extender for Sterling B2B Integrator combines the business process management features of Sterling B2B Integrator with the universal transformation capability of WebSphere Transformation Extender. This integration provides options for solving B2B and Application-to-Application (A2A) integration problems.

Capability	Why it matters
Trading partner management	Reuses SB2BI's existing partner records instead of re-modeling partners inside ITX
Enveloping and de-enveloping / bulking and de-bulking	Handles EDI envelope structures and batch document splitting around the ITX map
Document management and archive	SB2BI's document tracking and archival wraps around ITX-processed documents
Automated acknowledgment generation	SB2BI generates functional acknowledgments for documents ITX transformed
Reporting	Standard SB2BI reporting covers ITX-mapped transactions alongside every other document type
Managed file transfer with Sterling File Gateway	ITX maps can sit inside a managed file transfer flow, not just a point-to-point translation

WTX Map Service In order for WTX maps to operate in Sterling B2B Integrator, the WTX map service must be added. The service is available with installations of WTX 8.4 or later, and you need a licensed installation of WTX to access it.

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ITX in the Broader IBM B2B Portfolio

Global Mailbox Provides data storage replicated across geographically distributed locations, so mailbox-triggered application processing keeps working even if a data center becomes unreachable.

Partner Engagement Manager (PEM) A multi-enterprise B2B engagement portal for collaboration, monitoring, and visibility of activity flows between an organization and its partners.

ITX Advanced The modular, standards-based evolution of the Universal Transformation strategy, spanning WTX, Sterling B2B Integrator, and XSLT translation maps.

Control Center A centralized monitoring and management system for operations teams watching business activity across Sterling products and FTP servers.

Takeaway *ITX is one piece of a larger B2B stack — knowing where it sits helps you scope a real integration project correctly.*

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From ITX to Sterling Map Editor: Tooling and Architecture

Same job, different tool Map Editor and ITX solve the same problem — translating one structured document into another — and both are built around the same underlying idea: define what the source looks like, define what the target looks like, then describe field by field how one becomes the other. Where they differ is where that description lives, and how much of it is a fixed menu of choices versus free-form scripting. Since you already know ITX, use this table to translate what you know into what you're about to see on screen.

ITX concept	Sterling Map Editor equivalent	What's different
ITX Design Studio — a separate, licensed install	Map Editor — a free download from inside Sterling B2B Integrator itself	No additional license; installed once on any machine that will build maps
Type tree from a COBOL copybook, DFDL, or XML schema	Type tree from an X12/EDIFACT/positional/XML/CSV standard, via the New Map Wizard	Same concept, built from Sterling B2B Integrator's own standards database
A map service invoked as a business-process step	The compiled map is named directly inside the envelope's Translation/Compliance Checking setup	No separate invoke step — translation happens as part of enveloping / de-enveloping
A design tool's Test perspective	Test Map, or SI Map Test	Same purpose — run sample input, inspect the output before deploying
Mapping notes kept ad hoc, inside the map's function graph	GAP Analysis — a named, formal phase in Map Editor's own methodology: pair every output field with its input source before linking or ruling anything	Same idea, made an explicit step — you'll practice this exact phase in the hands-on lab

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From ITX to Sterling Map Editor: The Five Operations

Framing Every mapping tool you will ever use — ITX, or Sterling Map Editor in the hands-on lab that follows — is doing exactly one of five things to a field. Once you can name which of the five a field needs, configuring the map is just picking the right building block, in whichever tool you're using.

Operation	ITX mechanism	Sterling Map Editor mechanism
Copy	A copy card or straight-through link in the map graph	Simple Link — drag the input field directly onto the compatible output field
Reformat	A reformat or string function built into the palette	Extended Rule — a short assignment statement in Map Editor's own scripting language, e.g. string concatenation with the + operator
Compute	A compute card (sum, arithmetic, comparison)	Use Accumulator Standard Rule for running sums/counts across a loop; Extended Rule for comparisons or multi-field arithmetic
Default	A default value set on the target field	Use Constant Standard Rule
Lookup	A lookup table (cross-reference table built into the map)	Use Code Standard Rule (an editable code list built inside Map Editor) or Use Select Standard Rule (a trading partner code list or process-data section)

The one asymmetry worth knowing Map Editor's fixed Standard Rule list has no generic "reformat" rule, so most reformatting becomes a small Extended Rule instead of a drag-and-drop function card. Everything else lines up closely enough that if you can name the operation, you already know which Map Editor mechanism to reach for.

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Where ITX Fits vs. Sterling Map Editor

	Sterling Map Editor (native to SB2BI)	ITX (heavyweight, standards-based)
License	Included — a companion Windows download, no separate license	Separate license, separate Design Studio and runtime
Best for	EDI, positional, and XML mapping — the same map types used in the hands-on lab that follows	Very high-volume, complex, standards-heavy transformations at extreme scale
What you'll build today	A full 837 claim to 835 remittance flow, hands-on, immediately after this lecture	Not installed in this environment — covered conceptually only
Overhead	No extra install, no extra runtime to license or maintain	Extra install, extra runtime, extra license and maintenance

The bottom line Same underlying idea as Map Editor — just a heavier tool for a heavier job. The choice between them is a cost/complexity trade-off, not a technical requirement.

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Myth vs. Reality

Myth	Reality
"ITX replaces Sterling B2B Integrator"	ITX handles transformation only — SB2BI still owns business process orchestration, partner management, and monitoring
"Once you have ITX, you stop using native Sterling mapping"	Teams typically use both: ITX for heavyweight standards-based maps, Map Editor for everything else
"ITX is a plug-in inside the SB2BI Admin Console"	ITX is a separate application with its own Design Studio client and runtime engine, integrated via the ITXA adapter
"Any B2B Integrator license includes ITX"	ITX requires its own separate license and installation — it is not bundled

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ITX Integration Architecture

What it actually requires Integrating ITX with Sterling B2B Integrator is a multi-piece install, not a single download — worth knowing even though this environment runs entirely on Map Editor.

Piece	Role
ITX Design Studio	The Eclipse-based client used to build type trees and maps — typically installed on a Windows or Linux workstation, separate from the SB2BI server
ITX runtime/engine	Executes compiled maps; current IBM documentation refers to this generation as "IBM Sterling Transformation Extender," at the 11.0.x release line
ITXA (ITX Adapter for SB2BI)	Formerly the "WTX adapter" — installed on every SB2BI node via a vendor-provided script (e.g. InstallWTXService.sh on Unix/Linux) so a business process can invoke an ITX map
Container Integration path	A newer, container-based alternative to the classic adapter install, for environments that prefer Docker/Podman-based deployment
WTX Map Service	The SB2BI-side service required for WTX/ITX maps to operate — available with WTX 8.4 or later, and requires a licensed installation of WTX to access

Does every node need it? IBM support documentation directly addresses this question: "Do you need to install ITX with every node of Sterling Integrator?" The answer depends on your cluster topology and which nodes actually execute business processes that invoke ITX maps. In a clustered SB2BI environment, plan the ITXA install alongside your node architecture, not as an afterthought per box.

A JRE/JDK version and OS combination that's on IBM's compatibility matrix for both your ITX version and Sterling B2B Integrator 6.1 — check the Software Product Compatibility Reports site before provisioning any box.

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Licensing and Procurement Considerations

Consideration	Detail
Separate license	ITX requires a valid IBM entitlement/license separate from your Sterling B2B Integrator license
No self-serve trial	No evidence of a public self-serve trial download for ITX — provisioning it means a conversation with IBM or your organization's IBM account team
Procurement channel	IBM Passport Advantage, or your existing IBM account relationship
Compatibility check	Confirm JRE/JDK + OS combination against IBM's compatibility matrix for both ITX and SB2BI 6.1 before provisioning
Support lifecycle	Watch release lines — e.g. the 10.1.x line reaches end of support April 30, 2026; plan upgrades accordingly

What to do in the meantime If your organization eventually licenses ITX for real, the checklist above is the procurement list to hand to your infrastructure team. Until then, the hands-on lab that follows this lesson builds the identical business outcome — a claim in, a remittance out — entirely on Sterling Map Editor, with nothing further to install or license.

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When to Reach for Which Mapping Tool

Sterling Map Editor A field needs a straightforward copy, reformat, compute, default, or lookup, inside a flow you already own.

ITX Transformation volume and standards complexity are extreme, and a dedicated tool and team will maintain the maps.

Either tool Enveloping/de-enveloping, document archive, and acknowledgment generation are native Sterling B2B Integrator behavior regardless of which tool performs the translation.

Not sure yet? Start with Sterling Map Editor — its ceiling is lower than ITX's, but its floor (cost, learning curve) is far easier to justify first.

Either way *Name the operation (copy/reformat/compute/default/lookup) before you configure anything — the tool is secondary to naming the job.*

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Quiz

1. What does ITXA stand for, and what does it let a business process do?
2. Name two of the six capabilities the WTX-for-Sterling integration adds beyond raw transformation.
3. True or false: any Sterling B2B Integrator license includes ITX.
4. Which of the five universal mapping operations builds a field that doesn't exist in the source at all?
5. Which Sterling Map Editor Standard Rule corresponds most closely to an ITX lookup table, and which one corresponds to an ITX default value?
6. What is the current IBM product name for what many teams still call WebSphere Transformation Extender (WTX)?
7. Name one thing you should check before provisioning a box for ITX, besides the license itself.
8. Why might a clustered Sterling B2B Integrator environment NOT need ITXA installed on every single node?
9. In Sterling Map Editor, which mechanism handles most "reformat" operations, given that there is no generic reformat Standard Rule?

Lesson Review

In this lesson, you learned what IBM Sterling Transformation Extender (ITX) is and how it relates to WebSphere Transformation Extender (WTX); how the WTX-for-Sterling integration adds trading partner management, enveloping/de-enveloping, document archive, acknowledgment generation, reporting, and managed file transfer around raw transformation; and a shared framework — copy, reformat, compute, default, and lookup — that applies to any mapping tool, ITX or Sterling Map Editor. You also worked through a direct, side-by-side translation of every ITX concept you already know into its Sterling Map Editor equivalent, and the real architecture (Design Studio, runtime, ITXA adapter or container path, WTX Map Service) and licensing (Passport Advantage, no self-serve trial) a real ITX integration requires. Everything from here is hands-on.

What's Next: The Hands-On Lab

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| <i>Move straight into it</i> | Open the 837 to 835 End-to-End Sterling Map Editor Guide now. It builds a complete healthcare claim-to-remittance flow — an inbound 837 claim map and an outbound 835 remittance map — entirely in Sterling Map Editor, with no ITX installation anywhere in the design. |
| <i>If a term looks unfamiliar</i> | The lab guide's own "How Sterling Map Editor Compares to ITX" section repeats the two comparison tables from this lesson in more depth, right where you'll need them — flip back to it the moment a menu or term doesn't match what you expected from ITX. |
| <i>What you'll build</i> | Two maps (an Inbound 837 5010 Map and an Outbound 835 5010 Map), each wired into Sterling B2B Integrator's native enveloping and de-enveloping architecture. Four exercises walk you through both maps and both wiring steps, field by field, with exact menu paths and the exact result you should see at every step. |

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